

Hadi Mohammadi

Senior AI & Data Science Expert · PhD in Explainable NLP

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Profile

Researcher in explainable NLP (PhD, Utrecht University) and Senior AI & Data Science Expert at AcademicTransfer. I build production LLM systems for ranking, matching, and evaluation, and I study how to make them transparent, reliable, and culturally fair.

Track record: six doctoral research projects, five competitively funded projects (over €40K) led end to end, and production AI used by 22 Dutch research universities. I release code and data with my work.

Professional Experience

AcademicTransfer, Senior AI & Data Science Expert

Utrecht, The Netherlands
Dec 2025 – present

- Technical lead of the AI intelligence layer and applicant-tracking system used by 22 Dutch research universities and university medical centres.
- Own the AI stack: CV creation and revision, semantic search, talent-pool matching, and best-candidate identification.
- Lead a national recognition-and-rewards policy analysis with Dr. Sanli Faez (Universiteiten van Nederland) and university policy makers.
- Building an e-learning programme for PhD candidates and researchers with the University of Amsterdam.

AcademicTransfer, AI & Data Science Expert

Utrecht, The Netherlands
Jan 2024 – Dec 2025

- Cut HR hiring time by 20% with the CV Priority Sorter (active learning + LLMs), built with Utrecht University, TU Delft, and Maastricht University.
- Raised candidate–job matching accuracy by 17% and halved manual effort with generative pipelines for CV insight extraction and de-identification.
- Shipped transformer models on Azure ML with MLflow, Docker, and CI/CD; evaluated ranking with A/B tests, uplift analysis, and bandit simulations.

Utrecht University, School of Economics, Researcher & NLP Developer, FIRMBACKBONE

Utrecht, The Netherlands
Feb 2024 – Mar 2024

- Built the fbb-sustainability-analysis-cli tool: keyword extraction and sustainability scoring of company websites.

SnowaTec (Innovation Center), Entekhab Electronic, Senior Data Scientist, Customer Behaviour

Tehran, Iran
Dec 2021 – Dec 2022

- Modernised the enterprise data warehouse and ETL, improving data accessibility by 16%.
- Defined company KPIs and a customer-satisfaction index (+2% satisfaction); built Power BI dashboards used at every management level.
- Deployed ML customer segmentation, lifting marketing impact by 7.5%.

Bdood.bikes (shared bicycle system), Head of Data Science & Business Intelligence Team

Tehran, Iran
Apr 2020 – Oct 2020

- Led the data science and BI team and its analytics roadmap.
- Launched dynamic pricing and ML usage prediction, raising revenue by 5%.
- Cut maintenance costs by 8% and relocation costs by 3% with fleet intelligence; raised station utilisation by 11%.
- Improved customer retention by 4.5% through user-behaviour analyses.

Bdood.bikes (shared bicycle system), Data Scientist

Tehran, Iran

- Reduced downtime by 3.8% with predictive maintenance and battery-health algorithms.
- Improved rider safety by 3% with GIS models identifying high-risk riders.
- Delivered marketing analytics behind a 6% rise in revenue and engagement.

July 2019 – Apr 2020

Education

PhD	Utrecht University , Explainable Natural Language Processing for Social Sciences	Utrecht, The Netherlands
	• Thesis: <i>Let Me Explain! Explainable NLP for Understanding Large Language Models</i>. • Department of Methodology & Statistics; member of the NLTP group and the Human Data Science Lab. • Supervisors: Dr. Robert A. Bagheri, Dr. Anastasia Giachanou, Prof. Dr. Daniel Ober-ski.	Feb 2023 – May 2026
MSc	University of Tehran , Industrial Engineering, Macro Systems	Tehran, Iran
	• GPA 18.96/20 (4/4); ranked 2nd among 50+ graduate students. • Thesis: dynamic pricing with demand learning via reinforcement learning under non-stationary customer behaviour. • Cognitive science research on customer behaviour with the Institute for Cognitive Science Studies (ICSS).	Sept 2018 – Apr 2021
BSc	Isfahan University of Technology, Golpayegan College of Engineering , Mechanical Engineering	Isfahan, Iran
		Sept 2011 – July 2016

Skills

Research: Explainable NLP, LLM evaluation and LLM-as-judge, fairness and cultural alignment, annotation reliability, human-AI collaboration.

ML & Statistics: Bayesian statistics, reinforcement learning, multi-armed bandits (Thompson sampling), transformers, topic modelling, A/B testing and uplift analysis, geospatial analysis, high-performance computing.

Engineering: Python (advanced), R, SQL, Bash; PyTorch, TensorFlow, Hugging Face, scikit-learn; RAG, agents, Model Context Protocol, vector databases; Azure ML, MLflow, Docker, CI/CD; Power BI; LaTeX.

Languages: Farsi (native), English (fluent), Dutch (A2, improving).

Publications

EvalMORAAL: Interpretable Chain-of-Thought and LLM-as-Judge Evaluation for Moral Alignment in Large Language Models	2026
Mohammadi, H. , Giachanou, A., Bagheri, R. A. aclanthology.org/2026.starsem-conference.34 (*SEM 2026 (ACL), pp. 497–515)	
Exploring Cultural Variations in Moral Judgments with Large Language Models	2026
Mohammadi, H. , Bagheri, R. A. clinjournal.org/clinj/article/view/238 (Computational Linguistics in the Netherlands Journal, Vol. 15, pp. 59–77)	
Evaluating GRPO and DPO for Faithful Chain-of-Thought Reasoning in LLMs	2025
Mohammadi, H. , Kozák, T., Giachanou, A. arxiv.org/abs/2512.22631 (arXiv preprint)	
Assessing the Reliability of LLM Annotations in the Context of Demographic Bias and Model Explanation	2025
Mohammadi, H. [†] , Shahedi, T. [†] , Mosteiro, P., Poesio, M., Bagheri, R. A., Giachanou, A. 10.18653/v1/2025.gebnlp-1.9 (GeBNLP Workshop, ACL 2025, pp. 92–104 ([†] equal contribution))	

- Do Large Language Models Understand Morality Across Cultures?** 2025
Mohammadi, H., Meijer, Y. F. S. S., Papadopoulou, E., Bagheri, R. A.
aclanthology.org/2025.luhme-1.3 (2nd LUHME Workshop, ECAI 2025, pp. 30–39)
- Explainability-Based Token Replacement on LLM-Generated Text** 2025
Mohammadi, H., Giachanou, A., Oberski, D. L., Bagheri, R. A.
arxiv.org/abs/2506.04050 (arXiv preprint)
- Explainability in Practice: A Survey of Explainable NLP Across Various Domains** 2025
Mohammadi, H., Bagheri, R. A., Giachanou, A., Oberski, D. L.
arxiv.org/abs/2502.00837 (arXiv preprint)
- Measuring Firm Characteristics with Natural Language Processing (NLP) Models: An Error-Mitigating Framework with Tutorial Guidance** 2025
Oberski, D. L., Domenech, J., Garcia-Bernardo, J., Gerbrands, P., Hassink, W., **Mohammadi, H.**, Mustica, P., Schilpzand, R., Witteloostuijn, A.
(Strategic Organization (under revision))
- Novel Approaches in Financial Fraud Detection: Hybrid Machine Learning and Uncertainty-Based Deep Learning** 2024
Mohammadi, H., Rahmati, M., Shahedi, T.
(BNAIC/BeNeLearn 2024, Utrecht, The Netherlands)
- A Transparent Pipeline for Identifying Sexism in Social Media: Combining Explainability with Model Prediction** 2024
Mohammadi, H., Giachanou, A., Bagheri, R. A.
[10.3390/app14198620](https://doi.org/10.3390/app14198620) (Applied Sciences, 14(19), 8620)
- The CLIN33 Shared Task on the Detection of Text Generated by Large Language Models** 2024
Fivez, P., Daelemans, W., Van de Cruys, T., Kashnitsky, Y., Chamezopoulos, S., **Mohammadi, H.**, Giachanou, A., Bagheri, R. A., Poelman, W., Vladika, J., Ploeger, E., Bjerva, J., Matthes, F., van Halteren, H.
clinjournal.org/clinj/article/view/182 (Computational Linguistics in the Netherlands Journal, 13, 233–259)
- Towards Robust Online Sexism Detection: A Multi-Model Approach with BERT, XLM-RoBERTa, and DistilBERT for EXIST 2023 Tasks** 2023
Mohammadi, H., Giachanou, A., Bagheri, R. A.
ceur-ws.org/Vol-3497/paper-085.pdf (Working Notes of CLEF 2023, CEUR-WS Vol-3497, pp. 1000–1011)
- Statistical Reinforcement Learning with Application in Dynamic Pricing Problem: Learning from Customer Interaction based on Bayesian Approach** 2022
Mohammadi, H.
(Tehran: Arshadan Publication (book, in Persian))
- Home Health Care Problem with Synchronization Visits and Considering Samples Transferring Time: A Case Study in Tehran, Iran** 2022
Mirabnejad, M., **Mohammadi, H.**, Mirzabaghi, M., Aghsami, A., Jolai, F., Yazdani, M.
[10.3390/ijerph192215036](https://doi.org/10.3390/ijerph192215036) (International Journal of Environmental Research and Public Health, 19(22), 15036)

Grants & Awards

- **Best Oral Presentation**, IOPS Winter Conference 2025 — cultural moral alignment in LLMs (Dec 2025).
- **Applied Data Science Grant, €5K** — CV Priority Sorter for fair prioritization; with R. A. Bagheri, G. Kreml, J. Sparla (Dec 2025).
- **Applied Data Science Grant, €5K** — rule extraction from human evaluation with LLMs and RL; with A. Giachanou, S. Wang (Jul 2025).
- **CUCo Spark Grant, €9K** — ReDOSE: circular pharmaceutical industry using AI; with WUR, TU/e, and UMCU collaborators (May 2025).
- **ENFIELD grant, €14.4K** — European Lighthouse on Trustworthy and Green AI: user perspectives on explainable AI (Dec 2024).
- **Applied Data Science Grant, €7.5K** — reliability of annotations under model predictions and explanations; with P. Mosteiro Romero, A. Giachanou, M. Poesio (Dec 2023).
- **Admission scholarship**, Explainable AI Summer School, TU Delft (Aug 2022).
- **Ranked 2nd** among 50+ Industrial Engineering graduate students, University of Tehran (2021).
- **Best Paper Award**, 2nd National Conference of the Iranian System Dynamics Society (2019).
- **Ranked 35th** of 10,000+ in the national Iranian MSc entrance exam, Industrial Engineering (2018).

Teaching & Supervision

- **MSc thesis co-supervision, Applied Data Science, Utrecht University** — 2024: M. Meijer, E. Papadopoulou, L. Santos Moitinho de Almeida (with R. A. Bagheri); 2025: H. Brouwer, T. Kozák, M. Jouhar (with A. Giachanou); 2026: A. Vos, G. Verestiuc, T. Rietman (with R. A. Bagheri).
- **Practical Assistant**, Transformers Workshop, UMC Utrecht — Python sessions with Dr. Robert A. Bagheri and Prof. Dr. Albert Gatt (Dec 2023).
- **Computer Lab Assistant**, Data Wrangling and Data Analysis, MSc Applied Data Science, Utrecht University (Sep–Oct 2023).
- **Lead Teaching Assistant**, Deep Learning Summer School, Neuromatch Academy — international cohort, remote (Aug–Sep 2021).

Leadership & Service

- **Co-founder, NLP@U Young Scholar Network** — community of PhD candidates, postdocs, and junior NLP researchers across Utrecht University and UMC Utrecht (Nov 2024).
- **Communications Chair, BNAIC/BeNeLearn 2024** — Joint International Scientific Conferences on AI and Machine Learning, Utrecht University.
- **LERU Doctoral Summer School representative** for the Faculty of Social and Behavioural Sciences, Utrecht University (2025).

Professional Development

Generative Modeling Summer School, TU Eindhoven	June 2024
Machine Learning Summer School, University of Oxford — finance & NLP/health	May – July 2023
Explainable AI Summer School, TU Delft — post-hoc interpretability	August 2022
Executive Master in Finance, Sharif University of Technology	Nov 2021 – Nov 2022

References

- Dr. Robert A. Bagheri — Associate Professor, Methodology & Statistics, Utrecht University — a.bagheri@uu.nl
- Dr. Anastasia Giachanou — Assistant Professor, Methodology & Statistics, Utrecht University — a.giachanou@uu.nl
- Prof. Dr. Daniel Oberski — Professor of Social Data Science, Utrecht University; Scientific Director, ODISSEI — d.l.oberski@uu.nl